



A BlackBerry with a keyboard?

The new BlackBerry Motion from TCL will be all touchscreen and is ditching the iconic keyboard <http://dgit.in/bberrymotion>



Galaxy S8 texts disappearing

Samsung Galaxy S8 users are reporting that some phones are failing to receive text messages, and it isn't clear why. <http://dgit.in/gs8texts>

Xiaomi Mi Mix 2

Almost a true flagship

Having sold millions of phones in India, Xiaomi is yet to crack the flagship market. So, as they passed on the Mi 6 this year, it seemed like the right idea to choose the Mi Mix 2 instead.

The Mix series has a short history, beginning only last year. It's meant to prove that Xiaomi isn't a company that makes affordable phones only. It's a mascot, for innovation and creativity. It's meant to prove that Xiaomi is capable of making uber premium devices and bring them to market before others. The Mix isn't a first of its kind phone, but it's a phone that meets every modern standard you can think of.

Camera

The Mi Mix 2's camera is easily outperformed by any flagship today, mid or high-end. It takes reasonable photos in daylight, although you can see fine noise when you enlarge them. Details are also low and they reduce in low light or indoor shots. Shadow details are low and photos shot at night remain sub-par. Thankfully, colours and white balance are decent and the camera is quite fast to shoot with. Overall there's still work to be done on the camera.

Build and Design

Most of the Mi Mix 2's defining elements are in its design. You find a larger black border around the screen, as compared to last year's Mi Mix, although the form factor is smaller. The Mix 2 is also thinner, and all of that together makes for a compact smartphone, despite a 6 inch screen.

Due to the smaller form factor, the finish feels tighter and the body more solid. Xiaomi is only selling the ceramic variant here in India. Hence, your Mi Mix 2 is fragile but easier to



Price
₹37,999



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wipe fingerprints off of. The rounded metal sides provide better grip and increased robustness. The round, golden-accented camera module is slightly raised, with the flash next to it and a similar fingerprint sensor below it. Below that is

"Mix Designed By Xiaomi", a declaration by the company that it can make a phone like the Mix 2. With the proximity sensor behind the display, there's also a minor earpiece notch on the top.

Based simply on design, the Mix 2 is miles ahead of mid-ranged flagships like the OnePlus 5 and Honor 8 Pro and would easily impress budget buyers who yearn for the premium feel a phone priced at 50k brings.

Display

Due to cost cutting, a 1080p display is all you get, although the lack of bezels make it feel much more immersive on the Mix 2. While Gorilla Glass 2 feels quite premium, we would have preferred an AMOLED panel on the Mix 2. Instead, you get 403 ppi pixel

density and 18:9 aspect ratio display that still feels excellent.

Performance

Being Xiaomi's flagship, the Mix 2 is also Xiaomi's fastest smartphone to date. Additionally, there's also 128GB storage inside which is the most storage you can get on mid-ranged phones.

The Mix 2 sets high benchmark scores and the same is seen on regular usage as well. Xiaomi has tuned the software to reduce app load times. The Mi Mix 2 is snappy and responsive, although not as fast as the OnePlus 5. The earpiece on the Mix 2 is cleaner this time. Due to extensive LTE bands, meaning you can literally use it anywhere. On the OS front, you get MIUI8, and all that it brings.

Battery

The phone runs on a comparatively small 3400 mAh battery. On a week-end, with only a few calls and toned down usage, the phone easily surpassed 15 hours on a single charge. For most users, the phone will easily last at least 12 hours on each charge. The PC Mark battery test returns a score of nearly 12 hours to bring the battery down from 80% to 20%, which is the highest amongst flagships on our tests.

Verdict

The Xiaomi Mi Mix 2 looks premium, feels high end and it's fast. It doesn't set new heights in terms of what flagships can be, but it certainly proves what Xiaomi is capable of.

The Mi Mix 2 matches any phone in terms of speed, design or build quality. Where it fails though is in terms of camera performance. While the Mix 2 will impress those who want a flagship design, it's not the perfect mid-ranged flagship and certainly not the best buy.

—Prasid Banerjee

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 835 | GPU: Adreno 540 | OS: Android 7.1 (Nougat) | CARD SLOT: NA | DISPLAY TYPE: IPS | SIZE: 5.99-inches | RESOLUTION: 1080 x 2160 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: 12 MP, f/2.0, OIS | CAMERA SECONDARY: 5 MP, f/2.0.

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